

LOD / SoundExchange Checklist

What it is: the **artist** signs a Letter of Direction (LOD) telling SoundExchange to pay part of the artist's digital-radio royalties to the producer's company. Only the artist can sign it.

Why it comes first: the producer's signature waits until the artist's LOD is in. That's the only leverage we have to get it.

Part A — Get the artist's LOD (before the producer signs)

- ☐ LOD requested from the artist's attorney/label (Email 03) — **send it with the contracting info, not after release**
- ☐ Producer company + % on the LOD confirmed from the agreement
- ☐ Song title / recording information confirmed
- ☐ Producer + attorney told to **hold signature**
- ☐ LOD sent to the artist for e-signature (save the notice)
- ☐ **Artist-signed LOD PDF** saved
- ☐ **Certificate of completion** saved

Part B — Check the certificate (all must pass)

- ☐ It's the e-signature platform's own completion page (not a screenshot of an email)
- ☐ Document ID or document name matches the LOD
- ☐ Signer = the artist named on the LOD
- ☐ Status says **Completed**, with a date/time
- ☐ Signature is a real e-signature or ink, not a pasted image
- ☐ Payee company on the LOD = the agreement
- ☐ % on the LOD = the agreement
- ☐ Names and titles spelled correctly

All pass → **the producer may sign** (card 04, Part C). Any fail → Email 03, "correction" version. Wrong payee or % →  **Escalate.**

Part C — After the agreement is fully executed

- ☐ Who submits the LOD to SoundExchange, confirmed in writing
- ☐ **LOD submitted** — proof saved (email, case number, or dated screenshot)
- ☐ **Active at SoundExchange** — SoundExchange email or dated portal screenshot
- ☐ Everything uploaded to 04_SoundExchange_LOD/

Check "active" every **10 business days**. Not active after **3 checks** →  **Escalate.**

What doesn't count

They say / you have	It is
"I sent the LOD"	Sent — not signed
"He signed it"	Nothing until the PDF is saved
Signed LOD, no certificate	Not verified
Signed LOD + certificate	Verified — but not proof SoundExchange has it

If it's missing

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ACTION REQUIRED: Request LOD documentation → Email 03.